

Curriculum Vitae

GASSAB Mourad **Project Director**

Date of birth: 18/09/1971

Language skills: Arabic (Native), French (C1), English (B2)

Education and Qualifications

June 1996

Master's Degree in Civil Engineering, National Engineering School of Tunis (ENIT)

Memberships

Active member of the Alumni Association of the National Engineering School of Tunis (ADENIT), 2000–2010

Tunisian Order of Engineers

Professional profile

Chief Civil Engineer specialized in the management, leadership, technical assistance, and supervision of railway, road, and urban infrastructure projects. With over 28 years of experience in major structuring projects in Tunisia and internationally (Mozambique, Algeria, Gabon), he has developed strong expertise in the railway sector.

Recognized for his strategic leadership, analytical mindset, and ability to manage complex projects while working closely with institutional and technical stakeholders. An experienced manager, he has held senior executive positions such as Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Deputy Chief Executive Officer, Head of Mission, and Advisor to executive management.

Results-oriented, with strong synthesis skills and technical rigor, he has in-depth knowledge of project management procedures, multidisciplinary coordination, and international donor-funded project standards.

Highlights

- 28 years of experience
- Management of complex railway projects (design and execution phases)
- Strategic management of public transport organizations (**SNCFT, RFR**)
- Technical assistance and advisory support to executive management
- Coordination of engineering missions in Tunisia and internationally
- Leadership of multidisciplinary technical teams
- Planning, monitoring, process management, and supervision
- Strong command of French, Arabic, and professional English

Work experience (summary)

Since 05/2025 –
Present

Company: ARX
Position: Project Director

04/2024 – 04/2025

Employer: SETEC International
Position: Project Manager

03/2023 – 03/2024

Employer: STUDI International
Position: Project Manager

03/2021 – 02/2023

Company: Tunisian National Railways (SNCFT)
Position: Advisor to the Chief Executive Officer

08/2019 – 02/2021

Company: Tunisian National Railways (SNCFT)
Position: Deputy Chief Executive Officer

04/2016 – 07/2019	Company: Rapid Rail Network of Tunis (RFR) Position: Chief Executive Officer
09/2015 – 04/2016	Company: Rapid Rail Network of Tunis (RFR) Position: Director of Civil Engineering Division
08/2012 – 09/2015	Company: Rapid Rail Network of Tunis (RFR) Position: Project Director
08/2010 – 08/2012	Employer: STUDI International Position: Deputy Mission Manager – Mozambique
01/2000 – 08/2010	Company: Tunisian National Railways (SNCFT) Position: Project Manager
10/1996 – 12/2000	Company: Tunisian National Railways (SNCFT) Position: Senior Engineer – Assistant Project Manager

Main references

Bridges & Other Civil Engineering Structures

2025	Function: Project Director
Project	Detailed Design for the Construction of the Kenitra–Marrakech High-Speed Railway (HSR), Lot 4 – Linear Section Berrechid–Settat, including standard engineering structures and the Settat Ascent Viaduct
Client	TGCC
Cost, period	May 2025 – Present
Description	The project covers 55 km of railway platform between Berrechid and Settat and includes 56 standard engineering structures, comprising: • 23 Road Overpasses (ROPs), including reinstatement of associated roads (PSDA type) • 15 Hydraulic structures (box culverts), single and multiple spans • 9 Railway bridges (rail overpasses) of PICF type • Settat Ascent Viaduct, a non-standard major structure located at PK 381: Mixed-use bridge with simply supported steel twin-girder (PRS) spans. Total length: 1,500 m, consisting of 30 simply supported spans of 48 m each, designed for a design speed of 420 km/h.
Services, Project phases	• Coordinate the detailed design activities among ARX design teams (standard structures, earthworks, and viaduct), the construction company TGCC, ONCF, the Engineer (MOE), and the Project Management Consultant (AMO) • Prepare and submit regular progress reports to the client and key stakeholders • Provide technical support during the construction supervision phase, including resolution of structural issues • Participate in weekly progress meetings with the Engineer (MOE)

2008 – 2010	Function: Project Manager – Head of Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Repair and strengthening of engineering structures (24 pedestrian footbridges and various railway structures)
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Cost, period	2008 – 2010
Description	Supervision of construction, repair, and strengthening works for pedestrian footbridges and reinforced concrete and steel railway structures across several railway lines.
Services, Project phases	• Preparation of technical specifications and tender documents. • Review and study of projects for the preparation of bidding documents. • Approval of design studies related to the contracts. • Management of the procurement process, including technical and financial bid evaluation and contract award. • Supervision and quality control of construction works to ensure compliance with technical requirements. • Review, verification, and approval of structural calculation notes, shop drawings, and other contractual documents submitted by contractors. • On-site control of: Reinforcement works (rebar inspection), Formwork and Concrete casting • Monitoring compliance with the construction schedule. • Verification of joint measurements (quantities). • Financial monitoring of the project and approval of contractors' monthly payment statements. • Management of provisional acceptance of completed works.
2007 – 2008	Function: Project Manager – Head of Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Repair and strengthening of engineering structures; construction of passenger building at Gafsa
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Cost, period	2007 – 2008
Description	• Protection and stabilization of railway embankments and track platforms along the Tunis–Ghardimaou line (PK 89 to PK 214), including earthworks and geotechnical works. • Construction of a new passenger building in Gafsa with associated site development works (VRD) and road connections • Repair of four steel engineering structures on Line 15 between Metlaoui and Selja.
Services, Project phases	• Preparation of technical specifications, tender documents, and contract award procedures. • Supervision and quality control of earthworks, civil engineering structures, and construction works. • Monitoring project schedules and verification of quantities (contradictory measurements). • Approval of design studies and technical documents. • Financial management, including approval of monthly payments, final settlement of contracts, and preparation of ten-year warranty (decennial insurance) dossiers. • Supervision and compliance with project timelines for three main contracts: • Earthworks • Engineering structures • Management of provisional and final acceptance of completed works
2005 – 2007	Function : Project Manager – Head of the Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Repair and strengthening of engineering structures
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Cost, period	2005 – 2007
Description	• Strengthening of several composite steel structures and waterproofing of railway sections. • Supervision of strengthening works for four steel engineering structures on the Tunis–Ghardimaou railway line, with spans ranging from 20 to 80 m, and one steel engineering structure on the Mateur–Bizerte line. • Supervision of construction and strengthening works for three composite steel engineering structures (box girders) on the Tunis–Ghardimaou line, with spans ranging from 90 to 120 m. • Supervision of waterproofing works on the Tunis–Ghardimaou railway line between Jendouba and Ghardimaou (Lot No. 3).
Services, Project phases	• Preparation of technical specifications, tendering procedures, and quality control. • Schedule monitoring, quantity take-offs, and provisional and final acceptance. • Financial monitoring, final settlement, and ten-year warranty documentation.

2000 – 2003	Function : Project Manager – Head of the Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Repair and strengthening of engineering structures
Project	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Client	2000 – 2003
Cost, period	- Platform stabilization, strengthening of steel structures, geotechnical works, and construction of a port railway spur. - Supervision of platform stabilization and earthworks at PK 131+200 on the Tunis–Ghardimaou line, including geotechnical works. - Supervision of strengthening works for steel engineering structures at PK 131+300 (100 m) and PK 143+100 (120 m) on the Tunis–Ghardimaou line. - Supervision of reconstruction works of the engineering structure at PK 116 on the Graiba–Gafsa line (30 m span), including earthworks and geotechnical works for the temporary deviation. - Supervision of earthworks and geotechnical works for the railway spur to the Port of Gabès for petroleum coke transport. - Supervision of reconstruction works of six 15 m steel spans of the engineering structure over Oued Baiech. - Supervision of waterproofing works on the Tunis–Ghardimaou line between Tebourba and Oued Zarga (Lot No. 1).
Services, Project phases	- Preparation of technical specifications, procurement procedures, and quality control. - Schedule monitoring, quantity take-offs, acceptance of works, and contract payments. - Financial monitoring and ten-year warranty documentation.
2003 – 2004	Function : Project Manager – Head of the Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Reconstruction of Steel Bridges and Consolidation of Railway Platform
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Cost, periode	2003 – 2004
Description	Reconstruction of steel bridges between Tunis and Kasserine, waterproofing of the railway line, and consolidation of the railway platform. Monitoring of reconstruction works for 8 steel structures between Tunis and Kasserine, with spans ranging from 10 m to 50 m and 20 m to 80 m, as well as one steel structure on the Mateur–Bizerte line. Monitoring of reconstruction works for 4 steel bridges between Tunis and Kasserine with spans between 10 m and 50 m. Monitoring of works for waterproofing of the Tunis–Ghardimaou line between Oued Zarga and Jendouba (Lot No. 2). Monitoring of repair works on steel structures at PK 15 and PK 17 on the Metlaoui–Moularès line. Monitoring of consolidation and construction of 20 km of railway platform on Line 3 between Mateur and Béja.
Services, Project phases	- Preparation of specifications, contract award procedures, and monitoring of works. - Provisional and final acceptance of works, including schedule and financial monitoring. - Settlement of contracts and preparation of ten-year insurance files. - Approval of technical studies. - Preparation of specifications and tender documents. - Award of contracts (evaluation of technical and financial bids) and preparation of contracts with contractors. - Control and supervision of construction works related to the five (5) contracts. - Monitoring and enforcement of work schedules. - Approval of joint measurements of works. - Financial monitoring of the project and approval of contractors' monthly payment statements. - Final settlement of contracts. - Preparation of ten-year insurance documentation for the projects.

1996-1999	Function : Project Manager – Head of the Division for Repair and Strengthening of Engineering Structures
Project	Strengthening and reconstruction of steel and reinforced concrete structures (90 structures).
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Coût, période	1996 – 1999
Description	Strengthening and repair of 90 steel and reinforced concrete structures between Tunis and Gabès.
Services, Project phases	• Supervision and quality control of works. • Procurement management, including tendering procedures, schedule monitoring, joint quantity measurements, and financial follow-up. • Provisional and final acceptance of works, contract settlement, and ten-year insurance (decennial liability) documentation. • Tendering process management, including technical and financial bid evaluation and contract preparation with contractors. • Approval of design and technical studies. • Supervision and monitoring of construction works for engineering structures. • Monitoring and compliance with the construction schedule. • Approval of joint quantity measurements. • Project financial monitoring and approval of contractors' monthly payment statements. • Provisional and final acceptance of works. • Final settlement of contracts. • Preparation of ten-year insurance documentation for the projects.

Road projects

August 2010 – July 2012	Function: Head of Mission – Mozambique
Project	Supervision and quality control of the construction of the Montepuez–Ruaça road (135 km) – Mozambique
Client	ANE – Mozambique
Cost, period	August 2010 – July 2012
Description	Construction of the 135 km Montepuez–Ruaça road. Construction of 7 reinforced concrete engineering structures with spans ranging from 20 to 50 m. Construction of 150 hydraulic structures (culverts and pipes) with openings ranging from 1.2 m to 6 m.
Services, Project phases	• Supervision and quality control of earthworks, pavement, and engineering structures. • Verification and approval of geometric design (roads, roundabouts, intersections). • Review of execution drawings, calculation notes, and contract documents. • Inspection of structures (reinforcement, formwork, concreting). • Implementation of safety measures (HSE). • Management of claims, joint quantity measurements, financial follow-up, reporting, and schedule monitoring.

Railway projects

2024 – 2025

Function: Project manager

Project

Transgabonais Upgrade Program

Client

SETRAG (Gabon)

Cost, period

April 2024 – April 2025

Description

The 646 km Transgabonais railway line, featuring 28 level crossings and facing increased traffic and unstable zones, required an ambitious rehabilitation program including:

- Alkali-reactivity control for 18 bridges (Lot 1)
- Anti-corrosion and superstructure works for 33 bridges (Lot 2)
- Rehabilitation of 33 hydraulic structures using polymerization
- Reinforcement of 7 embankments (earthworks)
- Treatment of 22 priority bridges (piers, abutments, riverbanks)
- Securing 28 level crossings and pavement resurfacing

Services,

Project phases

- Verification of site layout, compliance with execution plans, and daily supervision of works.
- Quality control of materials, laboratory testing, and compliance with technical specifications.
- Preparation of written reports and joint documentation of works.
- Regular progress reporting, technical support in supervision, and management of structural risks.
- Coordination with legal, financial, and contractor teams.
- Management of study and construction schedules, final inspection up to project acceptance.
- Verification of executed quantities, approval of interim payments, and quality control of materials and works.

2023 – 2024	Function: Project manager
Project	Construction of the double-track line between Oued Sly and Yellel (93 km) – Algiers–Oran railway line
Client	SNTF (Algeria)
Cost, period	March 1, 2023 – March 30, 2024
Description	The project is part of the national railway modernization policy aimed at reducing travel time between Algiers and Oran, increasing traffic, modernizing operational conditions, eliminating level crossings through grade-separated structures, and constructing new passenger facilities.
	Earthworks: 3,446,084 m ³ (stripping, embankment, cut)
	Track laying: 135,587 m
	Drainage and sanitation structures: 130 units
	Engineering structures:
	• 18 road bridges (PS and PI) with spans of 25–100 m, including associated roadworks
	• 8 railway bridges with spans of 50–150 m
	• Passenger stations and halts: 7 units with platforms, boundary walls, utilities, and connecting roadworks
	• Warehouses: 2 units
	• Detailed track works: installation of new track V2 (92.6 km), correction of track V1 (22.512 km), service tracks, removal/reinstallation of track 1, 160 track devices (including 9 reused).
	• Verification of site layout and alignment markers.
	• Review and implementation of contractor execution plans.
	• Daily supervision of earthworks, engineering structures, roadworks, stations, roundabouts, intersections, and interchanges.
	• Verification of compliance of completed works and management of design modifications.
	• Structural analysis and recommendations for the design and construction of passenger stations.
	• Technical advice and supervision throughout the project lifecycle (design to construction), ensuring compliance with specifications.
	• Close collaboration with architects, engineers, and contractors for integration of structures and facades.
	• Review of contractor laboratory tests, quality control of materials and implementation.
	• Management of design modifications and engineering solutions.
	• Identification and management of risks related to design, fabrication, and installation.
	• Regular progress reporting and technical support for construction supervision.
	• Coordination with legal and financial departments.
	• Monitoring project progress through coordination meetings, ensuring structural obligations are met.
	• Preparation of written notes for final control and joint documentation.
	• Review of study and construction schedules, monitoring executed quantities, and approval of interim payments.
	• Quality control of materials and works.
	• Organization of periodic meetings with the contractor and preparation of reports.

Project	Management of the railway network operations of the Tunisian National Railway Company (SNCFT), Tunisia
Client	Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)
Cost, periode	August 2019 – March 2021
Description	•
Prestations, phases de projet	• Weekly monitoring of train delays and incidents, as well as slowdowns. • Decision-making for problem resolution, including urgent railway works and technical inspections of civil engineering structures. • Monitoring of investment projects and management of issues with contracting companies. • Oversight of rolling stock condition and management (main lines, suburban lines, freight). • Financial monitoring (recovery of funds, debt payments). • Monitoring of staff training. • Overall coordination of operations and project progress, including infrastructure, rolling stock, planning, and operation of main and suburban lines.
2012 – 2019	Function : • Chairman and CEO (April 2016 – August 2019) • Director of Civil Engineering Division (September 2015 – April 2016) • Project Director of Line D (August 2012 – September 2015)
Projet	Tunis Rapid Rail Network (RFR) – Lines E and D, Tunisia
Client	Réseau Ferroviaire Rapide de Tunis (RFR)
Coût, période	August 2012 – July 2019
Description	Construction Monitoring : • Underground railway tunnel (278 m, NATM method), entrance structures (diaphragm walls, piles, retaining walls). • Line D: 12.2 km of earthworks, 4 reinforced concrete road bridges (61 m to 171 m), 4 underground road crossings, 13 pedestrian bridges, 8 stations (700 to 1,900 m²) with utilities and roadworks. • Line E: 6.2 km of earthworks, 1 reinforced concrete road structure, 3 railway viaducts (1,400 m), 5 stations with utilities and roadworks. • Systems works: track laying (3 tracks on Line D, 2 tracks on Line E), overhead catenary installation, signaling, PCC, telecommunications.
Prestations, phases de projet	• Approval of technical studies (topography, soil, water, road facilities, buildings, structural frameworks). • Review and approval of execution plans according to design office plans (earthworks, platforms, civil engineering structures, viaducts, stations, site developments). • Resolution of technical issues (road engineering structures, viaducts) and management of conflicts with local residents. • Planning, preparation of specifications, schedule monitoring, and site supervision in coordination with project managers and site supervisors. • Integration of environmental standards. • Preparation of progress reports (reporting). • Financial monitoring and approval of monthly statements. • Management of RFR company under the supervision of the Ministry of Transport. • Coordination with clients and stakeholders (contracting companies, project managers, owner's representatives, control offices, SNCFT). • Risk management and adherence to overall project schedule. • Follow-up with funding agencies (AFD, EIB, KfW). • Strategic decision-making and guidance for project managers. • Supervision and support of project managers.

Buildings

2007 – 2008

Project

Client

Cost, period

Description

Services,

Project phases

Function: Project Manager – Head of the Structures Repair and Strengthening Division

Repair and strengthening of engineering structures; construction of the passenger building in Gafsa.

Société Nationale des Chemins de Fer Tunisien (SNCFT)

2007 – 2008

Protection and stabilization of embankments and railway platforms; construction of the passenger building and utilities and roadworks.

- Preparation of specifications, tender documents, and contract award procedures.
- Monitoring and supervision of works (earthworks, civil engineering structures).
- Schedule control, joint measurements, and provisional and final acceptance of works.
- Financial monitoring, settlement of contracts, and management of ten-year insurance files.